THE MASTERMIND COACHING CLASSES

CBSE / RBSE • NURSERY – CLASS XII • JAIPUR

Road No. 5, VKIA, Jaipur — 9887258679

CLASS 10 — ENGLISH · HARD LEVEL CHAPTER TEST SET 1

Chapter 15: **The Making of a Scientist (Footprints Without Feet)** | RBSE Pattern | Session 2026–27

Time: 1 Hour 30 Minutes Name: _____ Roll No.: _____ **Maximum Marks: 40**

General Instructions:

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. Q. 1–10 are Objective Type (1 mark each).
3. Q. 11–14 are Very Short Answer Type (2 marks each).
4. Q. 15–18 are Short Answer Type (3 marks each).
5. Q. 19–20 are Long Answer Type (5 marks each).
6. Internal choice is given in Q. 17 to 20.
7. Write the question number before each answer.
8. Hard level: application and higher-order questions.

SECTION — A (Objective Type Questions) 10 × 1 = 10

Choose the correct option and write it in your answer book.

1. The chapter's central argument about talent is that it: 1

(a) is purely inborn
(b) depends on wealth
(c) is a matter of luck
(d) grows through curiosity, support and effort

2. Which concept links collecting and classification? 1

(a) geometry **(b)** trade **(c)** taxonomy **(d)** poetry

3. The effect of the chronological structure is to: 1

(a) show gradual growth **(b)** confuse the reader
(c) hide the ending **(d)** create suspense

4. Which of these best explains why the discovery about the gold spots matters? 1

(a) it won a medal
(b) it made butterflies bigger
(c) it ended tagging
(d) it overturned the assumption that they were only ornamental

5. The shift from hobby to research is marked by: 1

(a) bigger collections only **(b)** systematic questioning and experiment
(c) more friends **(d)** more spending

6. What is the significance of Richard's use of simple methods (tagging, observation)? 1

(a) only adults can research
(b) only machines matter
(c) great discoveries may begin with simple tools
(d) simple methods are useless

7. The author's purpose is mainly to: 1

(a) inspire readers by a real example **(b)** sell books
(c) criticise teachers **(d)** entertain with jokes

8. Which of these is an ethical concern in animal tagging? 1

(a) cost of tags **(b)** avoiding harm to the animal
(c) colour of tags **(d)** noise

9. Which of these questions is most open-ended? 1

(a) Who wrote the chapter?
(b) Where is Harvard?
(c) How can schools nurture young scientists like Richard?
(d) What is a pupa?

10. Which statement shows critical thinking in Richard's approach? 1

(a) he tested whether the viceroy truly imitates the monarch
(b) he copied others
(c) he accepted every claim
(d) he avoided questions

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer Type) — 4 × 2 = 8

Answer in about 20–30 words each.

11. Evaluate how the writer makes scientific content accessible to students. 2

12. Comment on the importance of context (home, school, mentor) in the making of a scientist. 2

13. What values besides curiosity does the chapter promote? 2

14. How does the chapter challenge the image of the scientist as a genius apart from others? 2

SECTION — C (Short Answer Type) — 4 × 3 = 12

Answer in about 40–60 words each.

15. Discuss the extent to which environment shapes a scientist in the chapter. 3

16. What does the chapter imply about the role of play in learning? 3

17. Explain the term 'hypothesis' with an example from the chapter. 3

OR

Analyse the writer's selection of events to build the portrait of Ebright. 3

18. Compare Richard Ebright with Griffin from 'Footprints Without Feet' as scientists. 3

OR

How might the chapter be used to promote scientific temper? 3

SECTION — D (Long Answer Type) — 2 × 5 = 10

Answer in about 100–150 words each.

19. 'Curiosity, support and effort make a scientist.' Evaluate this statement in the light of the chapter. 5

OR

Evaluate the role of luck versus effort in Richard's success. 5

20. Analyse the structure and style of the biography. 5

OR

Write a talk for students on 'Mimicry in Nature' linking it to Richard's project. 5

END OF QUESTION PAPER — Total: 40 Marks

MASTERMIND